

Chapter 33 Part 6

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Xu Qingzhu had to go out to meet clients in the afternoon, so Liang Shi stayed home alone.

Their department was actually working overtime too. She had an online meeting with Li Ran and Zhou Li to discuss the interview with Zhao Ying. The interview draft was handled by Li Ran, while Liang Shi helped her out, basically just checking for typos.

After Li Ran logged off, a little child appeared in Zhou Li's camera.

Rainbow greeted her, "Sister Liang Shi, do you have any other sci-fi movie recommendations? I'm in a drama drought."

Liang Shi: "..."

She still hadn't gotten used to Rainbow, this genius girl.

With such a childish face, speaking to her coolly as an equal.

Nevertheless, Liang Shi responsibly made her a list of films.

Rainbow was very polite, "Thank you, Sister Liang Shi."

Liang Shi said it was no problem.

After hanging up the video conference, Liang Shi had nothing else to do. Li Ran's article wasn't finished yet, so naturally it wasn't her turn to proofread.

With nothing better to do, she rewatched 《Lonely Island》 again.

In her memory, she had indeed watched this movie when she was ten years old.

But this movie was released when she was five.

Yet she had no memories from before age eight.

Very few people actually knew about this. Liang Shi never mentioned it to anyone. Apart from her grandparents, basically no one particularly close had appeared in her life.

Although her agent and assistant were very good to her, and she was generally well-liked wherever she went, she was used to being independent.

According to her grandparents, her parents died when she was eight years old.

When she was eight, she had a serious illness and then lost all her memories.

She didn't remember her parents, nor did she remember what she had experienced before age eight. But her grandparents were especially good to her. Even though the family was very poor, her grandparents would do their utmost to give her the best and provided her with much warmth.

When she was in elementary school, many people would ask about her parents, and she would say, "My parents went to a very distant place."

For a long time, Liang Shi was very sad.

She wasn't sad about not having parents or lacking parental love compared to others, but rather sad that she had lost all memories of her parents.

Her parents must be very heartbroken, right?

She had once told her grandmother this, but grandmother comforted her, "Your parents would be very happy to see you as you are now."

So she asked, "What was I like before?"

Grandmother smiled without speaking, stroking her head and saying, "You've always been the most well-behaved child."

Liang Shi was reminded of unpleasant memories, and halfway through watching, her heart felt heavy, so she turned off the movie.

In the evening, Liang Shi hastily ate a few bites of dinner and went to bed early after washing up, not even encountering Xu Qingzhu.

The next morning when she got up, she saw Xu Qingzhu.

And... Xu Qingzhu was in the kitchen.

Liang Shi immediately ran in, asking in surprise, "What are you doing?"

Xu Qingzhu answered calmly, "Making breakfast."

Liang Shi: "?"

"I decided to prove my cooking skills to you." Xu Qingzhu wore heat-resistant gloves, with steaming hot rice porridge cooking in the pot, "Although it's not a feast, I can still make simple meals."

Liang Shi: "Alright."

She just didn't know if it would be edible.

Liang Shi felt she might transform into a lab rat.

Xu Qingzhu ladled the rice porridge into bowls and brought them to the table before saying, "If my words yesterday caused you any harm, I apologize."

Liang Shi: "...?"

"I was too impulsive yesterday." Xu Qingzhu said, "I remembered some unpleasant things."

Liang Shi shook her head, "It's fine. Did something happen yesterday? I've forgotten."

"Are you a fish?" Xu Qingzhu teased, then let the matter drop.

Xu Qingzhu ate quietly. The rice porridge was sweet and barely edible.

After eating, Liang Shi washed the dishes.

She couldn't help but ask, "Did that phrase remind you of someone?"

Xu Qingzhu shrugged, "I thought of a very brave sister who also liked to say that phrase."

"So you suspected I was her?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu nodded, "But I think that sister is probably dead."

Dead forever in her heart.

Yesterday has passed and cannot be retained.

She shouldn't have held onto hope.

Hearing this, Liang Shi could only offer comfort, "My condolences."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

"By the way, I have friends coming this afternoon. Is that okay?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

"Is it Sally and Lin Luoxi?"

"There's them, plus my psychiatrist." Xu Qingzhu said, "She wants to see my living environment. It's a follow-up examination."

"That's fine. Do I need to avoid them?" Liang Shi asked.

"No need." Xu Qingzhu said, "Just pretend we don't exist."

Sally and Cherry were coming for work, and Dr. Gu wasn't just coming for her follow-up examination.

But Liang Shi didn't need to know that much.

As they were talking, the doorbell rang.

This house had never really had guests before, so the doorbell rarely rang. Its sudden ringing now surprised both Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu, and they exchanged glances.

"Is it Sally and Lin Luoxi?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu shook her head, "They were working on drawings until very late last night. They probably haven't gotten up yet."

While speaking, she went to open the door. After opening it, she saw a little girl with princess braids. Xu Qingzhu recognized her immediately, "Lingdang¹?"

Lingdang was holding a panda plushie and bowed to greet her in a childish voice, "Hello, Aunt."

Xu Qingzhu smiled, "How did you suddenly come here? Did you come by yourself?"

"No, Mommy brought me." Lingdang pointed behind her, where a gentle woman was standing.

"Second sister-in-law." Xu Qingzhu greeted her, and the woman replied gently, "Sister-in-law, long time no see."

"Is Ah Shi here?" Second sister-in-law said, "I need to go back to my mother's house. Her father is on a business trip, and Lingdang insisted on coming to play at Aunt's house, so I could only bring her here. If you have time today, could you help look after Lingdang?"

Liang Shi came out of the kitchen, and Lingdang's eyes lit up as she called out, "Auntie, play games with me!"

Liang Shi hadn't expected such a pleasant surprise and immediately came over to hug Lingdang, "How did you come here?"

"Don't you welcome me?" Lingdang pouted.

"I'm overjoyed." Liang Shi hugged her and spun her around.

Standing to the side, Xu Qingzhu watched quietly.

Once again questioning life—since when did Liang Shi start enjoying playing with Lingdang?

Footnotes: ¹ Lingdang (铃铛) - literally means "little bell," a cute nickname for the child